



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	8th November 2023	Time of Incident	12.08pm
Directorate / Region	RMO – Midwest Gascoyne	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	SHW Procedure Breach	EQSafe Incident Number	35211
Actual Consequence	Insignificant	Potential Consequence	Major

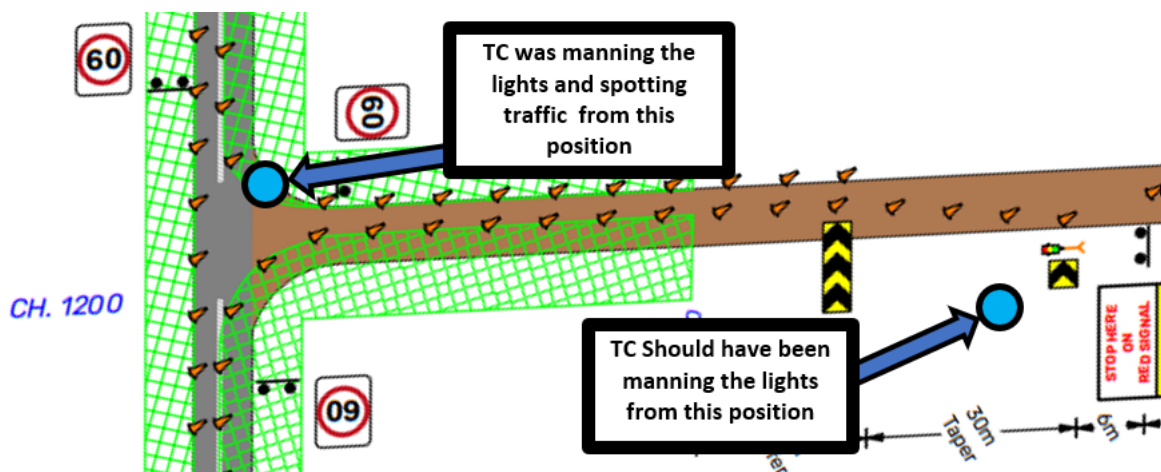
Incident Short Description	Traffic Controller on foot within 1.2m in a 60km speed zone
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Executive Summary

On the 8th of November 2023 works had been scheduled at the intersection of Bookara East Road. The work scope required 3 traffic control points, North and South bound of Brand highway with a single lane closure and a third control point located on Bookara East Road.

Due to limited space and field of view, a Traffic Controller had been stationed at the intersection located on Bookara East Road and Brand Highway. The TC had been tasked with spotting traffic entering and exiting the intersection, communicating with the mobile plant operator and shifting cones when required.

At approximately 12:08pm a Main Roads representative entered the work area to conduct a traffic audit, and has observed a TC standing within 1.2m of a live lane under a 60km/h speed reduction. The Main Roads representative addressed the behaviour observed with the TC and the incident was reported shortly after to the principal contractor's HSEQ Advisor.



Incident Photos

Traffic Controller standing on delineation line

Contributing Factors

- The project team failed to identify/ recognise the hazards and risks present at the congested work site. The traffic management SWMS was not reviewed or amended to suit nor was a Take 5 completed.
- The traffic Management SWMS failed to manage and adequately control the critical risks associated with traffic management and the movement of mobile plant / vehicles and workers on foot. E.g. Exclusion zone distances for workers on foot from live traffic.
- The Traffic Management Plan failed to provide an option for works to be undertaken and managed under a speed reduction of 40km per hour for workers on foot within 1.2m.
- Lack of adequate resources and task planning to complete the task safely. 4 x TC's were arranged however 1x TC failed to attend site. The replacement traffic controller failed to meet the onboarding requirements.

Corrective Actions

- Review and amend TMP to develop and include TGS's for speed reductions to 40km/hr.
- Safety leadership interactions and site inspection KPI's to be met by the Principal Contractor to ensure all Critical Risks inclusive of Traffic Management and Mobile Plant is being controlled.
- Review and amend SWMS to ensure adequate controls are in place for Traffic Management and Mobile Plant risks and hazards.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- The Site Supervisor allowed for works to commence even though they knew they were under resourced at the time.
- The traffic management contractor failed to ensure that the replacement TC fulfilled the personnel onboarding requirements prior to attending site.
- Congestion on site had not been addressed.
- Additional risks were created by expecting the TC to undertake spotting tasks in conjunction with normal traffic control duties.

**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to
Interaction with Live Traffic

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations